

VINCENT NWOSU

University of Calgary
School of Languages, Linguistics, Literatures and Cultures
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. candidate in Linguistics | University of Calgary | expected 2026
Dissertation: The LabPhon Study of the Igbo Verbal Arts
Committee: Darin Flynn (chair), Kathryn Franich (co-chair, Harvard University), Steve Winters, Ozouf Amedegnato

M.A. in Linguistics and Cognitive Science | University of Delaware | 2023
Thesis: Acoustic Analysis of Implosives in Igbo
Advisor: Kathryn Franich

M.A. in English Language and Philosophy | Ahmadu Bello University, Nigeria | 2019
Thesis: A Stylo-Linguistic Analysis of Elnathan John's *Born on a Tuesday* and Adam Ibrahim Abubakar's *Season of Crimson Blossoms*
Advisor: Amodu Jonah Enejoh

B.A. in English and Literary Studies | Ahmadu Bello University, Nigeria | 2016

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed articles and chapters

2026 Nwosu, V. Automatic and Non-Automatic Downstep in Igbo Are Not Realized the Same. In *Proc. SpeechProsody 2026* (pp. 555-558).

2026 Nwosu, V. Singing to Children in Igbo: An Acoustic Analysis of Pitch and Voice Quality. In *Proc. SpeechProsody 2026* (pp. 740-744).

2026 Franich, K., and **Nwosu, V.** Prosody and Predictability in the Timing of Co-Speech Gestures: Evidence from Igbo 'Gesture Shift'. *Laboratory Phonology*. DOI: 10.16995/labphon.18890

2025 Franich, K., Keupdjio, H., and **Nwosu, V.** The timing of speech and gesture in two Niger-Congo languages: Implications for word-level prominence. *Glossa* 10(1). doi: <https://doi.org/10.16995/glossa.17426>

In Press

Nwosu, V. and Franich, K. The Acoustic Analysis of Implosives in the Igbo Language. In: *Non-pulmonic consonants*. Ed. by Bonny Sands, Anne-Maria Fehn, Jeremy Pasternack, and Amanda Miller. *Studies in Phonetics and Phonology*. Toronto: University of Toronto Press.

Nwosu, V. and Franich, K. Phonetic correlates of Igbo storytelling. *Selected Proceedings of the Annual Conference on African Linguistics (ACAL)* 55.

Nwosu, V. Rhythmic constraints on vowel coalescence in Igbo: Evidence from children's songs. *Laboratory Phonology*.

Nwosu, V. Inconsistent Tone Spreading in Igbo. *Proceedings of the Association of Contemporary African Linguistics (ACAL)* 55.

Under Review

Nwosu, V. (revised & submitted). 'The owl never cries in vain': An acoustic study of vocal expressions in *mbem* chants. *Frontiers in Communication*.

Nwosu, V. (submitted). Prosodic Account of Negation In Igbo. *Studies in African Linguistics*.

Nwosu, V., Ukaegbu, M. N., & Akinbo, S. (submitted). Tonal Adaptations in Igbo Child-Directed Speech. *Proceedings of the Association of Contemporary African Linguistics (ACAL)* 56.

Amoniyani, A. O. & **Nwosu, V.** (submitted). It does exist in Nigerian English: An argument for FACE vowel variation using supervised machine learning classifiers. *Proceedings of the Association of Contemporary African Linguistics (ACAL)* 56.

Nwosu, V. & Flynn, D. (submitted). The Productivity of the Rhythm Rule in Western Canadian English. *The Journal of English Linguistics*.

Nwosu, V & Eon-Suk Ko. (submitted). Tone Preservation under Prosodic Modulation: Evidence from Igbo Child-Directed Storytelling: Phonetic Evidence from Igbo. *Journal of Child Language*.

Nwosu, V. (submitted). Text-setting Constraints in Igbo Music: Evidence for Downstep Representation. In: *Illustrating African Phonologies* Volume 1. Ed by Braver, A & Bennett, W. Contemporary African Linguistic Series: Language Science Press.

Nwosu, V., Amoniyan, A.O., & Ezeamuzie, R.O. (submitted). The Phonetic Realization of Focus in Igbo. InterSpeech 2026.

Amoniyan, A. O. & **Nwosu, V.** (submitted). Prosodic Phrases in Englishes: From Inner-Circle to Nigerian English. InterSpeech 2026.

Nwosu, V. (submitted). Tone-Tune Correspondence in Igbo Liturgical Music: Downstep, Prosodic Conditioning and Compositional Grammar. *Language*.

Nwosu, V. (submitted). Probabilistic grammar and prosodic competence: A Maximum Entropy account of tone-tune correspondence in Igbo. *Laboratory Phonology*.

PRESENTATIONS

Conference Presentations

2026 Nwosu, V. Prosodic Cues to Backchanneling in Igbo Oral Narrative. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistic Association, University of Calgary, June 2026.

2026 Nwosu, V., & Franich, K. Cross-Dialectal Incomplete Neutralization in Igbo Implosives. Laboratory Phonology. McGill University, June 26-28, 2026.

2026 Nwosu, V., & Franich, K. Acoustic Analysis of Implosives in Igbo. 57th Annual Conference on African Linguistics, University of Buffalo, May 21-23, 2026.

2026 Nwosu, V. Automatic and Non-Automatic Downstep are not realised the same in Igbo. *Speech Prosody 2026*,

2026 Nwosu, V. Acoustic Analysis of Child-Directed Singing in Igbo. *Speech Prosody 2026*,

2025 Nwosu, V. & Flynn, D. The Productivity of the Rhythm Rule in Western Canadian English. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistic Association, McGill University, Montréal, QC, June 2025.

2025 Nwosu, V., Ukaegbu, M. N., & Akinbo, S. Tonal Adaptations in Igbo Child-Directed Speech. Paper presented at the 56th Annual Conference on African Linguistics, University of Minnesota, May 15-17, 2025.

2025 Franich, K. and **Nwosu, V.** Rhythmic Constraints on Vowel Coalescence in Igbo: Evidence from Children's Song. Paper presented at the 56th Annual Conference on African Linguistics, University of Minnesota, May 15-17, 2025.

2024 Nwosu, V. The Productivity of the Rhythm Rule in Western Canadian English. Paper presented at the Alberta Conference on Linguistics, University of Calgary, November 2024.

2024 Nwosu, V. Acoustic analysis of three Igbo Folk Songs. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistic Association, June 2024.

2024 Nwosu, V. & Franich, K. Phonetic Correlates of Igbo Storytelling. Paper presented at the 55th Annual Conference on African Linguistics (ACAL), Montréal, QC, May 2024.

2024 Nwosu, V. & Yeung, A. H. Inconsistent Tone Spreading in Igbo. Paper presented at the 55th Annual Conference on African Linguistics (ACAL), Montréal, QC, May 2024.

2024 Nwosu, V. & Yeung, A. H. Inconsistent Tone Spreading in Igbo. Poster presented at the Linguistic Society of America Annual Meeting, January 2024.

2023 Franich, K. and **Nwosu, V.** Timing of co-speech gesture in Igbo: Influence of metrical prominence and tonal melody. Paper presented at the Symposium Series on Multimodal Communication, Frankfurt, Germany, September 25-27, 2023.

2023 Franich, K. and **Nwosu, V.** Phrase Boundary and Tone Melody as Predictors of Co-Speech Gesture Timing in Igbo. Paper presented at LabPhon 19, Seoul, Korea, 2023.

Working Group and Lab Presentations

2024 Nwosu, V. Phonetic Correlates of Igbo Storytelling. Work-in-Progress talk presented at the Language Resource Centre, University of Calgary, 2024.

Invited Talks and Workshops

2026 Nwosu, V. When Speech Meets Rhythm: What Igbo Children's Songs Reveal About Language Structure. KIAS-MINDS-Chosun CDS Joint Workshop: Music, Mathematics & Language. Chosun University, Korea. June 18-20 2026.

2026 **Nwosu, V.** Prosodic Modulation in Child-Directed Storytelling: Phonetic Evidence from Igbo. POSTECH MINDS-Chosun CDS Joint Workshop, Chosun University, Korea. January 22 2026.

2023 Nwosu, V. Methods for phonetic analysis. Guest lecture and training presented at the Department of English, Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria, Nigeria, January 2023.

Ongoing. Nwosu, V. Fieldwork methods and data collection workshops. Training workshops for student research assistants on ELAN software, fieldwork protocols, and data collection methods for the Ika language documentation project.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Impact Coordinator | Faculty of Arts, University of Calgary | September 2025–present

Affiliate Member | Harvard Phonetics Lab, Harvard University | August 2023–present

Principal Investigator: Kathryn Franich

Graduate Research Assistant | University of Calgary | September 2023–present

Supervisor: Darin Flynn

Graduate Research Assistant | University of Delaware | August 2021–August 2023

Supervisor: Kathryn Franich

- Conducted fieldwork on speech timing in Kejom and Medumba (Cameroon)
- Ran experiments with 65 subjects in Yaoundé and Bamileke, Cameroon (Fall 2022, Winter 2023)

FIELDWORK & DOCUMENTATION EXPERIENCE

Language Consultant | 7C Lingo USA | November 2023–present

Igbo Language Documentation | Nigeria | 2019–present

- Collected over 57 hours of audiovisual recordings of Igbo verbal arts (storytelling, *mbem* chants, song)

Speech Timing Study | Cameroon | Fall 2022, Winter 2023

Principal Investigator: Kathryn Franich

Ika Language Documentation | Nigeria | 2017–present

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

2026 SSHRC Doctoral Award | \$120,000 CAD

2026 Flight 302 Legacy Award | \$10,000 CAD

2026 Public Humanities Fellowship, CIH, University of Calgary | 7,500 CAD

2025 Chosun HK Global Fellowship | \$4,500 CAD

2025 Alberta Graduate Excellence Scholarship | \$11,000 CAD

2025 Language Resource Centre Graduate Fellowship, University of Calgary | \$2,000 CAD

2025 Conference Travel Grant, School of Languages, Linguistics, Literatures and Cultures, University of Calgary | \$500 CAD

2024 Conference Travel Grant, School of Languages, Linguistics, Literatures and Cultures, University of Calgary | \$500 CAD

2023–present International Graduate Award, University of Calgary | \$3,000 CAD annually

2021–2023 Graduate Award Scholarship, University of Delaware | \$55,000 USD annually

HONORS & AWARDS

2026 Impact Award in Connection, Community and Culture, Faculty of Arts, University of Calgary

2016 Award for the Best Graduating Student, English Department, Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria

2012, 2013 Awards for the Best Teacher, Royal Crown Schools, Zaria, Nigeria

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant | University of Calgary | September 2023–present

School of Languages, Linguistics, Literatures and Cultures

Instructors: Darin Flynn, Elizabeth Ritter, Dennis Storoshenko

Teaching/Research Assistant | University of Delaware | August 2021–August 2023

Department of Linguistics

Instructors: Kathryn Franich, Nadia Pincus

Principal | Titsall High School, Abuja, Nigeria | January 2019–June 2021

Lecturer (Sandwich Program) | Federal College of Education, Zaria, Nigeria | May 2017–June 2018

Department of General Studies

Vice Principal | Royal Crown Schools, Zaria, Nigeria | July 2014–March 2017

SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

UNIVERSITY SERVICE

Organiser, Pitch at the Crossroads Workshop, Laboratory Phonology Conference, June 25-29, 2026

GSA Representative | Faculty of Arts Council, University of Calgary | 2025–2026

GSA Representative | Faculty Tenure and Promotion Committee, Faculty of Libraries and Cultural Resources, University of Calgary | November 2023–present

Awards Committee Member | Graduate Students Association, University of Calgary | September 2023–2025

Colloquium Committee Member | Department of Linguistics, University of Delaware | 2022–2023

COMMUNITY SERVICE AND OUTREACH

Volunteer Contributor | Nkowa Okwu (Igbo Online Dictionary) | November 2023–present

Student Engagement Leader | Mandela Washington Fellowship | April 2022–August 2023

Volunteer | Calgary Drop-In Center, Calgary, AB | 2023–present

Founder | Academic and Career Pacesetters Group (ACAPAG) | 2017–present

Founding Member | African Graduate Students' Association, University of Delaware | 2021–2023

Volunteer Literacy Instructor | Rural Outreach Program, Abuja, Nigeria | 2019–2020

Tutorial Class Facilitator | Department of English, Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria | 2014–2016

Volunteer Teacher | University Preparatory Classes | 2010–2012

EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

Editor | *The Roar*, Loyola Jesuit College, Abuja | 2018–2019

Chief Editor | *The Bambara*, Department of English, Ahmadu Bello University, Zaria | 2015–2016

Editor | *The Royal Searchlight*, Royal Crown Schools, Zaria, Nigeria | 2012–2015

MEDIA COVERAGE

2025 Nearly 300 Nigerian languages are endangered, some may disappear within a generation — Vincent Nwosu, language researcher. *Tribune Online*. url: tribuneonlineng.com/nearly-300-nigerian-languages-endangered-some-may-disappear-within-a-generation-vincent-nwosu-language-researcher/

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

- Linguistic Society of America
 - Canadian Linguistic Association
 - West African Linguistic Society
 - Association of Contemporary African Linguistics
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TECHNICAL SKILLS

Nwosu, Vincent - CV

Programming: R, Python, JavaScript

Software: Praat, ELAN, PsychoPy

LANGUAGES

Native: Igbo, Ika

Near-native: English

Intermediate: Latin, Hausa

Elementary: French, Arabic (equivalent to CEFR level A1)

Fieldwork knowledge: Kejom, Medumba

Last updated: April 2026